

Depending on the position and the business, the abilities necessary for such positions would vary substantially. The EC-Council, which administers the certification programme, specifies the following skills as required to pass the exam in order to achieve the highly sought-after Certified Ethical Hacker credential:

- Knowledge of networking and computer systems is essential.
- Current security methods for commonly used operating systems such as Linux, Windows, and Mac are understood.
- With permission, hack into a network or system to investigate vulnerabilities.
- Able to take preventative, corrective, and defensive steps in the face of malicious attempts
- Should be capable of recognising and breaking a variety of passwords.
- Should be able to remove digital evidence of network and system breaches and understand the phases and procedures of ethical hacking.
- Know how to use encryption and cryptography.
- Follow the code of ethics and professional behaviour.
- Should be knowledgeable of common cyberattacks such as phishing, social engineering, trojans, insider attacks, identity thefts, and so on, as well as how to avoid them using suitable evasion strategies and responses.

The EC-Council also recommends that prospective ethical hackers be fluent in a variety of programming languages, including Python, SQL, PHP, Java, C, and C++.

Ethical Hacker Salary Data

Because figures are frequently modified in real-time based on changing data, salary estimates for cybersecurity occupations related to ethical hacking vary greatly depending on the methodology utilised. The starting salaries for ethical hackers can vary between USD 80-120K but Indian salaries will be much lower.

Another form of an ethical hacker, freelance “bug bounty” hunters, can make a lot of money.

Both private enterprises and government agencies bolster their security systems by enlisting the help of freelance hackers to find faults that pose a threat to their overall security.

More than 100,000 hackers now work as bug bounty hunters, according to bug bounty portal HackerOne, with six earning more than \$1 million.